```
generateText({
    messages: [{
        role: 'user',
        content: 'Hello, what is your name?'
    }],
    model: model("models/gemini-2.0-flash")
});
```

The only reason to use this format is when you want a single interaction, since you cannot pass any history of messages like FAQs or one-off queries. Most of the time, you want to use the message prompt type since it is more flexible.

MESSAGES PROMPTS

Messages prompts are more complex and versatile and are typically used in multiturn conversations or when more context is needed. Examples may include language learning agents, retrieval-augmented generation applications, or technical support agents. They can be further categorized into

- *Simple messages*—These are basic messages with a role (e.g., user, assistant) and content.
- *Compound messages*—Compound messages include additional metadata or attachments, such as images or documents. We saw an example in chapter 4 when we were attaching an image to the prompt:

```
system: ({
   "messages":[
      {
         "role":"user ",
         "content":[
            {
               "type":"text",
               "text":"Describe the following image"
            },
            {
               "type":"image",
               "image":"data:image/png;base64..."
            }
         ]
      }
   ],
   "model": model("models/gemini-2.0-flash")
});
```

- *Tool call messages*—Tool call messages are used to instruct the AI to perform specific functions or API calls. This is basically a compound message using the type `'tool-call'` and passing additional information about the call parameters. Example use cases include automated booking systems, e-commerce, or automation agents: